set up precisely when Tito decided to break with Stalin (or vice-versa), as he wanted to imprison those of his political opponents who were the most faithful to Stalin and therefore, in one sense, perhaps the most genuine Communists. Hundreds died there between 1948 and 1963 in the most dreadful circumstances, akin to prison camps in North Korea. Tito's dictatorship could probably be best compared with those of General Franco in Spain or General Pinochet in Chile but Tito, himself titled the Marshal, can certainly be held responsible for many more victims than these counterparts from the opposite side of the political spectrum.

It is important to understand that living under Communist rule in, say, Poland could be quite different from living under it in Hungary or Slovenia. These differences also help to explain variances in developments in different Eastern European countries after 1990. While, for example, from the perspective of religious freedom in Soviet-dominated Poland, one was free to attend religious services, in Slovenia a teacher in a small town had to attend mass in a nearby city in order to avoid bullying at work. And Christmas was not a public holiday in Slovenia as it was in Czechoslovakia even though the country was almost overwhelmingly Catholic. On the other hand, while in Slovenia the Communist authorities left the Church a relatively high degree of autonomy in internal matters, in Czechoslovakia, the priestly occupation was regulated and vicars salaried by the State. As a result, a parallel underground Church was formed by those that wanted to remain independent – Tomáš Halík, the famous Catholic philosopher was one of its priests. The underground life in the then Czechoslovakia is also described in Roger Scruton's fictional *Notes from Underground*.

The experience above the ground also varied through the years of the Communist dictatorships. A joke about the Communist government could earn you years in prison in 1950s Slovenia but, in the 1980s, it would cost you a fine or, at most, a conditional sentence. The following is the experience of my own family.

My father's father was born at the end of the nineteenth century in a village that is today 20km from the Italian border, not far from the village of Vrhpolje, which I mentioned in the first chapter. He was born as a citizen of the Austro-Hungarian Empire. In World War I, he served in the Austrian army and, during a battle in the Tyrolean mountains, he lost his lower leg. As a result, he had to give up hopes of taking over the family farm and